

Sony is already working with NASA to make a VR simulation of Mars, based on the images sent back by the Mars Rover.

Having tried the DK2, many in the Digit team itself don't think this is a far fetched reality. When you put on an Oculus Rift (even at the stage it is in today), your mind believes it is in those digitally created worlds. It's not uncommon for first time users to move their hands about trying to reach out to grab those objects that are so convincingly there right in front of your eyes. Your senses are thoroughly fooled. Perhaps that would be the next step in the evolution of this category – fooling all of your senses.

Even now early adopters are combining controllers like the Razer Hydra to bring in tactile immersion into their gaming. So if for example you are using a gun in a game, you will need to flick the Hydra to reload your weapon, and because you are holding a rod in your hand it can bring you ever so closer into thinking it's the handle of a .45 Magnum. If you are a fan of innuendo think of the preceding sentence as a metaphor for another interesting application of this sunrise technology – porn.

We were both tickled and aghast recently when we saw the launch

SO HOW DOES THE RIFT WORK?

The first thing you need to know about the Rift is that it replaces your entire field of vision with a digitally created image. This doesn't mean that there is a wrap around screen in those chunky glasses. The screen is actually large enough to only take up about 100 degrees of your vision. On this screen the Oculus projects two images – one for each eye. A set of lenses then combines those two images into one stereoscopic image which gives the illusion of depth or what we commonly call 3D. It's kinda how you would see double when looking at an object that's very close to your eyes. But when you squint the two objects merge into one and focus clearly. Creating depth perception is only part of the process that creates true immersion though. The headset has sensors that detect orientation and a camera tracks your relative position in the environment through a series of IR markers on the headset. This enables 6 degrees of freedom of movement and is responsible for allowing you to lean into objects or peek around corners. Confused? You won't be once you build your own Rift. Be sure to check out page no. 12 of SKOAR where we show you how to build your own Oculus for about ₹500.

of a new case for the iPad called the Launchpad by none other than infamous sex toy maker Fleshlight. Without mincing words the attachment literally let you have sex with your iPad. Can you imagine something like that being ported for use with the Oculus Rift? If VR is going to make it so easy for you to get off, would you ever take it off?

You could easily find yourself living more and more in a VR environment. Want to watch a movie? How about experiencing a 50 foot screen right in

your home? Just pop on a VR headset and you could easily do that and in a more immersive way. This is not too far away considering the rate at which resolution for small screens (the kind used in VR headsets) is increasing. Even before a retail unit of a VR headset is in the market, filmmakers are already experimenting with the opportunities this technology opens up. Condition One's Zero Point is one example. It is the first 3D, 360-degree documentary film to be released exclusively for Oculus Rift. And this movie is more than just the illusion of a large screen created because it's so close to your face. The 20 minute movie has had people sweating in the midst of a military training exercise and even flying off a cliff apparently.

Extrapolating this further you have a real possibility of virtual presence devices. Yes, the kind Sheldon Cooper creates in the Big Bang Theory but infinitely more sophisticated. There could be motorised devices that will beam sensory information to you and you'll be in the comfort of your home wearing a VR head mount. Scary isn't it? Or exciting? Sounds a lot like the future we saw in the Bruce Willis starrer Surrogates.

Maybe years into the future we'll have VR-ready human with sockets for upgrades and eyeballs with focal length of about 4cms. How about thumbs with little fingers like a fractal explosion? You'll need all of them to control your virtual presence units. Maybe even monkey-style feet adapted to control an even bigger array of controllers! 🍌



Zero Point is a 3D, 360-degree documentary film